

# Kun Zhang

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CV · LinkedIn · GitHub

## Summary

Corporate finance and labor economics researcher focused on corporate governance, institutional ownership, and causal inference. Seeking a pre-doctoral RA position (2026–2027) toward a Ph.D. in Financial Economics.

## Working Paper

**Institutional Common Ownership and Executive Mobility: Evidence from the 2009 BlackRock–BGI Merger**  
*Supervisor: Prof. José Azar (IESE & UNAV)*

- Exploiting the BlackRock–BGI merger (2009) as a quasi-natural experiment, I examine how institutional common ownership shapes C-suite executive mobility.
- Constructed a 27.8-million-row firm-pair panel linking 13F holdings (58.9M obs.), ExecuComp data (31,959 executive-years), and Orbis director moves (24,716 transitions).
- Findings: common ownership increases mobility through within-network labor market channels—rejecting the shadow non-compete hypothesis.
- Results: Firm-level DiD  $+0.073$  ( $p = 0.002$ ); Pair-level logit  $\Delta\lambda = +0.582$  ( $p < 10^{-18}$ ); Event study post-2009 significant ( $p < 0.001$ ). Robust to 17 pair-level checks and 5 placebo tests.
- Link: [Paper Workflow](#)

## Conferences & Presentations

- Presented at IESE 2026, Madrid Work & Organizations Workshop, May 21–22, 2026.**  
*Institutional Common Ownership and Executive Mobility: Evidence from the 2009 BlackRock–BGI Merger*
- Roads to Development 2026 — Joseph Stiglitz (Nobel laureate in Economics)**  
*Democracy and Sustainable Human Development*
- IESE AI Conference 2026 — Raffaella Sadun (Harvard Business School)**
- 21st IESE Banking Industry Meeting**

## Education

- Universidad de Navarra** Sep. 2025 – Present  
Master in Economics and Finance (MEF), Pamplona, Spain  
Relevant coursework: Econometrics, Mathematical Economics, Real Analysis, Statistics.
- Hanyang University** Sep. 2023 – Jan. 2024  
Exchange, School of Economics, Seoul, Korea
- Yantai Institute of Technology** Sep. 2021 – Jul. 2024  
B.A. in Economics (International Economics & Trade), Shandong, China

## Projects & Experience

- ANDV-Behavioral-SEIRQ** (Python, behavioral modeling, real-time OSINT) Oct. 2025 – Present  
Built a high-fidelity SEIRQ model with extended behavioral and intervention variables, accurately forecasting the spread of Andes hantavirus (ANDV).
- Shandong Dongsheng Construction** — Accounting Intern Mar. 2024 – Jun. 2024  
Applied undergraduate Excel skills to data analysis, accounting, and Monte Carlo simulations; ran regressions using Python and Stata.

## Honors

- Outstanding Exchange Student Award (Hanyang, 2024)
- University Python Programming Champion (Yantai, 2023)

## Projects & Skills

- Exec-Mobility** (Python, pandas, statsmodels, NumPy, Stata, SQL, LaTeX, Git)
- CO-Workflow** (HTML, JavaScript, Git)
- Languages:** English (C1), Chinese (Native), Spanish (A2)

## References

**Prof. José Azar** (Thesis Supervisor), IESE Business School & Universidad de Navarra — [Jazar@unav.es](mailto:Jazar@unav.es)